

2000 - 78

RC FILE

RESULTS:

7-0 (A)

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

Rcd 12/28/00 upl

SPECIES: Inca Dove *Columbina inca*

DATE(S) OF OBSERVATION: First sighting: 12/20/00; second sighting 12/26/00; third sightings 12/27/00; fourth sighting 12/28/00

NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: adult plumage (Tom and I think that it is a male, but not positive.)

EXACT LOCATION: In my backyard, in downtown Fort Collins. 906 Stover Street.

COUNTY: Larimer

LENGTH OF OBSERVATION: First: ~10 min; second: ~45 minutes; third: ~30 minutes; fourth: 1.75 hours

TIME(S) OF OBSERVATION: First 9:00-9:10 hour; second: 12:30-1:15; third: 9:20 am and again around noon; fourth: 8:50-10:35 am

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO SAW THE BIRD(S) WITH YOU: None the first time; second time bird was identified by Laurie Zuckerman and Nick Komar; third time by L. Zuckerman and Richard Maxfield; fourth observation was L. Zuckerman, Randy Vernon, Alex Cringan, and Tom Mathies.

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY SAW THE BIRD(S): Julie and Phillip Vernon.

LIGHT CONDITIONS (QUALITY; DIRECTION RELATIVE TO BIRD(S); POSITION):

First time: Good, but overcast = diffuse; Second time: Good, sunny, bird in sunshine

Third time: Good, sunny, bird in sunshine; Fourth time: Good, sunny at first than more hazy overcast

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT USED: Nikon 10x binoculars, 32x spotting scope

DISTANCE FROM BIRD (ESTIMATED UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED): First time: 10 ft looking down on bird but through a screen-covered window. Second time: through a glass window at 25 feet. Third time: through a glass window at 25 feet. Fourth: from side yard of house about 30 feet of unobstructed view.

WAS BIRD PHOTOGRAPHED? Yes IF SO, HAVE YOU SUBMITTED PHOTOS? _____

WHO TOOK THE PHOTOGRAPHS? Nick Komar

DESCRIBE THE GENERAL AND SPECIFIC HABITAT IN WHICH THE BIRD(S) OCCURRED:

First time: In my backyard on lawn and on patio beneath bird feeder. Second time: In my backyard on wooden fence. Third time: In my backyard on wooden fence and lilac shrub behind fence. Also flying to backyard feeders at 711 Locust St. Fourth time: In my backyard in lilac shrub behind fence. Also sitting on phone wire six feet above fence line.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD'S BEHAVIOR (FLYING; FEEDING; HABITS; BEHAVIORS USED IN IDENTIFYING THE SPECIES OR IN SUPPORTING THE IDENTIFICATION):

Feeding, but nothing about this or any other behaviors that would help support or refute the conclusion that it was an Inca Dove. Sits and suns and preens in lilac tree or on fence. Seems to have a very itchy head and spends a lot of time scratching. Very quiet and sits in one spot for extended periods, mostly facing the sun, but often with back facing sun. Is a real sun worshipper. Occasionally flutters to another branch inside lilac. Seen flying to the ground several times behind fence. Seen flying across open yard next door.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD IN DETAIL: Was ~8 in long and was noticeably smaller than a Mourning Dove. The scalloped pattern covered most of its body including its back down to the rump, wings (scapulars, coverts), breast (upper and lower) as well as the underside of the rump. Rust color on the wings extremely obvious when bird was heavily preening. White tail feathers seen on underside of the tail which is long and thin. Red eye noted, but no obvious blue eye ring. Looks like the male adult in SIBLEY guide, but has much more contrast between back scalloping and breast scalloping. Breast is very light when bird faces sun. Salmon color feet. Thin dark bill.

DESCRIBE BIRD'S CALL OR SONG: N/A; No sound heard from yard.

DISCUSS SIMILAR SPECIES AND HOW YOU ELIMINATED THEM: Given that it was a small Columbiform, the Common Ground Dove is the only likely alternative. Eliminated it on the basis of its much shorter tail. The bird I saw was also had much more defined scalloping on the plumage and the scalloping covered much more of the body compared to the Common Ground Dove (see below).

WHAT IS YOUR PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES?
Never have seen this species. Have seen Common and Ruddy Ground Doves on a few occasions.

LIST BOOKS, GUIDES, RECORDINGS OR OTHER SOURCES CONSULTED AND HOW THIS INFLUENCED YOUR IDENTIFICATION (DURING AND AFTER OBSERVATION):

National Geographic used to decide during observation.

SIBLEY field guide used to confirm identification on fourth observations.

THIS REPORT WAS MADE FROM NOTES MADE IMMEDIATELY AFTER OBSERVATIONS.

DATE OF WRITTEN REPORT: begun 12/21/00 and finished 12/28/00

REPORTING OBSERVERS: Tom Mathies and Laurie Zuckerman

SIGNATURES: _____

OBSERVER ADDRESS: 906 Stover St. Fort Collins, Co 80524 970-482-5589